

SYMBIOSIS CENTER OF CORPORATE AND PROFESSIONAL LEARNING

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Forecasting Revenue Using Time Series Data

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1. Introduction:

➢ Background:



Jio Financial Services Limited (JFSL) is a prominent Indian financial services company that operates as a "new-age" digital-first institution. Originally a subsidiary of Reliance Industries Limited (RIL), it was demerged into an independent entity in July 2023 and listed on the Indian stock exchanges in August 2023.

Here is a breakdown of its company background:

1. History & Evolution

* Original Roots: It was originally incorporated in July 1999 as Reliance Strategic Investments Private Limited.

* The Demerger: In July 2023, the financial services arm of RIL was spun off. Shareholders of Reliance received one share of JFSL for every share they held in RIL.

* Strategic Rebirth: Post-demerger, the company was rebranded as Jio Financial Services Limited, shifting from a dormant holding entity to a full-scale financial services provider.

2. Business Segments

JFSL operates as a holding company, providing services through several key subsidiaries and joint ventures:

* Lending: Through Jio Finance Limited, it offers consumer and merchant loans (e.g., consumer durable loans, personal loans, and business loans).

* Insurance: Jio Insurance Broking Limited acts as a corporate agent and broker, offering digital insurance solutions.

* Payments: Jio Payment Solutions Limited manages the payment gateway and merchant solutions, while Jio Payments Bank (a joint venture) handles savings accounts and UPI.

* Investments & Wealth: JFSL has a 50:50 joint venture with BlackRock (the world's largest asset manager) to offer asset management, wealth management, and broking services in India.

* Leasing: Jio Leasing Services focuses on "Operating Lease" models, specifically for assets like AirFiber routers and other technology equipment.

3. Key Financials & Leadership

* Status: It is registered with the RBI as a Core Investment Company (CIC).

* Leadership: The company is led by industry veterans, including K.V. Kamath (Non-Executive Chairman) and Hitesh Sethia (MD & CEO).

* Market Position: As of early 2026, it remains one of the largest Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs) in India by market capitalization, benefiting from the massive ecosystem of Jio (telecom) and Reliance Retail.

4. Core Strategy

The company's primary goal is to "democratize finance" in India. It leverages a digital-first model to reach customers via the JioFinance App, aiming to provide simple, affordable, and accessible financial products to 1.4 billion Indians.

➢ Product line of JFSL:

Lending Solutions

Retail Lending: Consumer durable loans, personal loans, and device financing via the JioFinance app.

MSME Lending: Merchant loans, working capital products, and supply-chain finance for small businesses.

Payments & Banking

Jio Payments Bank: Offers CASA (Savings) accounts, money transfers, and bill payments to over 2.3 million customers.

JioPay: Provides UPI-based payments, merchant QR codes, and Point-of-Sale (POS) solutions like soundboxes.

Investments & Insurance

Jio BlackRock: A 50:50 joint venture offering digital-first asset management, mutual funds, and wealth solutions.

Insurance Broking: Distribution of life, health, motor, and general insurance policies embedded within the Jio ecosystem.

❖ SWOT Analysis:



Strengths

Massive Ecosystem: Access to Reliance's huge customer base across telecom and retail.

Strong Capital: High financial capacity and backing from Reliance Industries.

Digital-First: Low-cost distribution through the JioFinance app and paperless journeys.

Weaknesses

High PE Ratio: Valuation is high compared to current earnings.

Late Entry: Entering a highly competitive market already dominated by established banks and fintechs.

Opportunities

Jio BlackRock JV: Potential to disrupt the asset management industry with low-cost passive funds.

Rural Expansion: Driving financial inclusion in Tier 2–4 cities through digital lending.

Threats

Product Premiumization: Launching specialized credit products like Loans Against Mutual Funds and Enterprise Device Leasing.

Super-App Strategy: The JioFinance app integrates UPI, insurance, and investments into a single platform to improve customer retention.

AI Innovation: Using GenAI for automated underwriting, fraud detection, and customer support to lower operating costs.

➢ Significance of the Project:

Revenue forecasting is a cornerstone of strategic planning, especially for a dynamic entity like Jio Financial Services Limited (JFSL). In the highly competitive financial services sector, accurate forecasting is essential for capital allocation, risk management, and the scaling of digital-first financial products.

This project is significant because it utilizes **time series analysis** to evaluate JFSL's emerging market presence and project future revenue streams. Given that JFSL is in a high-growth phase, identifying trend patterns helps determine the sustainability of its business model and its ability to capture market share. These insights are critical for stakeholders, as they provide a data-driven outlook on the company's trajectory in a digital-native economy.

From an academic perspective, this study offers practical exposure to **fintech analytics**. It allows for the application of theoretical forecasting models to a real-world scenario where market volatility and digital adoption play a significant role.

➢ Scope of Work:

The scope of this project is focused on analyzing and forecasting the revenue of Jio Financial Services Limited using its historical financial performance and quarterly disclosures. It includes a systematic study of past revenue data, the identification of growth trends, and the estimation of future earnings based on these observed patterns.

The project utilizes fundamental analytical tools, including:

- Trend Analysis to track growth momentum.
- Simple Forecasting Methods to project short-to-medium term revenue.
- Graphical Representations to visualize the correlation between market events and financial outcomes.

Exclusions and Limitations: This study is specifically tailored to revenue trends and does not encompass a detailed audit of operational costs, bad debt ratios (NPAs), or the impact of complex regulatory changes. Furthermore, as JFSL is a relatively new independent entity, the study relies on the data available post-demerger and listing. The accuracy of these forecasts may be influenced by sudden shifts in the fintech regulatory landscape, changes in interest rates, or broader macroeconomic fluctuations.

2. Literature Review / Background Study:

➢ Review of Existing Studies:

Revenue forecasting and time series analysis are vital tools in the financial services sector to predict future earnings based on historical data. Many studies suggest that analyzing past trends helps financial institutions make better strategic decisions regarding capital allocation, credit risk management, and product scaling.

Time series forecasting methods—such as trend analysis, moving averages, and growth rate analysis—are commonly used to estimate future revenue. While traditional banking follows stable interest-income patterns, the **Fintech and NBFC sector** is characterized by rapid digital adoption and fluctuating transaction volumes. Therefore, time series analysis is considered an effective tool for identifying the "velocity" of growth in new-age financial entities like JFSL.

Recent studies on the financial sector highlight that revenue growth is driven by factors such as **digital ecosystem integration, loan book expansion (AUM), customer acquisition costs, and regulatory compliance.** Researchers have found that companies with a strong technological backbone and a diversified portfolio (lending, insurance, and payments) tend to show more resilient growth patterns compared to single-product firms.

In addition, previous research emphasizes using historical financial data—specifically **Net Interest Income (NII)** and **Fee Income**—to calculate growth trends. This approach is practical and widely used in both academic research and corporate valuation to forecast long-term sustainability.

➢ Gaps Identified:

1. **Complex Statistical Models:** Most existing research focuses on high-level econometric models that are difficult for retail investors or students to apply to a single, emerging company like JFSL.

2. **Lack of Company-Specific Focus:** Many studies analyze the "Indian NBFC Sector" as a whole rather than focusing on the unique, ecosystem-led model of **Jio Financial Services**, which limits specific insights into its individual performance.
3. **Ignoring Rapid Market Shifts:** Forecasting models often fail to account for sudden shifts in the digital economy, such as changes in **UPI transaction policies, interest rate hikes by the RBI, or aggressive competition** from established fintech apps.
4. **Need for a Simple Approach:** This project addresses these gaps by using a clear and practical method to analyze historical data and forecast revenue, making the financial health of JFSL easy to understand for all stakeholders.

3. Problem Statement & Objectives

➢ Problem Statement:

In today's volatile financial environment, companies must continuously monitor and predict their financial performance to maintain investor confidence and liquidity. For a rapidly growing NBFC like **Jio Financial Services Limited**, revenue forecasting is essential for managing the loan book, planning digital infrastructure investments, and maintaining a competitive edge in the crowded Indian fintech market.

➢ Objectives of the Project:

The primary aim of this project is to analyze the financial trajectory of Jio Financial Services Limited and provide a data-driven projection of its future earnings. The specific objectives are as follows:

- **To Analyze Historical Revenue Trends:** To examine the past financial performance and revenue streams of JFSL (including its post-listing disclosures) to understand its initial growth momentum in the NBFC sector.
- **To Apply Time Series Forecasting:** To utilize statistical methods such as trend analysis and moving averages to project the company's future revenue for the upcoming quarters.
- **To Identify Key Growth Drivers:** To study the factors influencing JFSL's income, such as digital lending expansion, brokerage services, and its integration within the larger Jio ecosystem.
- **To Evaluate Market Positioning:** To understand how JFSL's revenue model compares to traditional NBFCs and how its "digital-first" approach impacts its financial stability.

- **To Provide Actionable Insights:** To present the forecasted data through graphical representations that can assist investors and students in understanding the company's potential financial health.

4. Methodology / System Design

➢ Tools & Techniques Used:

In this project, analytical and quantitative tools are employed to evaluate and forecast the financial performance of Jio Financial Services Ltd. The primary technique applied is time series analysis, which is essential for studying historical financial data and identifying emerging trends within the NBFC (Non-Banking Financial Company) sector.

Data for this analysis is gathered from reliable secondary sources, including official annual reports, quarterly financial results, and statutory filings from the NSE and BSE. Microsoft Excel is utilized as the primary tool to organize large datasets, calculate Compounded Annual Growth Rates (CAGR), and develop visual representations such as charts and dashboards.

Basic techniques like trend analysis and comparative financial modeling are used to understand the pattern of revenue and profit changes. These methods provide a clear, academic framework for interpreting the company's scalability.

➢ Methodology:

The methodology follows a systematic, step-by-step process designed to analyze historical performance and forecast the future financial trajectory of JFSL:

Data Acquisition: Historical financial data, including Total Income, Net Profit, and Assets Under Management (AUM), is collected for the available fiscal periods.

Data Structuring: The raw data is organized into a tabular format to ensure clarity and ease of comparison between different financial quarters or years.

Growth Metrics Calculation: Year-on-year (YoY) and Quarter-on-quarter (QoQ) percentage changes are calculated to identify the underlying growth momentum.

Trend Observation: Trend analysis is performed to determine if the company's financial health shows consistent growth, stability, or volatility as it expands its service offerings (like insurance, broking, and lending).

Projections: Based on identified growth trends and market sentiment, an estimated growth rate is applied to forecast future revenue potential.

Visualization: The findings are translated into charts and graphs for better interpretation and presentation of the company's financial outlook.

The project is executed through the following distinct phases:

Data Collection: Gathering historical financial statements and market data from reliable financial portals.

Data Organization: Structuring the financial data into comprehensive spreadsheets for modeling.

Analysis: Calculating key financial ratios, growth rates, and identifying sector-specific trends.

Forecasting: Projecting future financial performance using trend analysis and market estimates.

Presentation: Summarizing the findings through visual aids, tables, and a final interpretive report.

5. Implementation / Execution:

The implementation phase focuses on applying the methodology to analyze and forecast the revenue of Jio Financial Services Ltd using historical performance data following its demerger and listing.

First, the revenue data of the company for the last five financial years (including its pre-listing period as a Reliance subsidiary) is collected and organized in a tabular format. This data includes the total annual revenue and the percentage increase or decrease compared to the previous year. For a newly listed entity like Jio Financial, organizing the data in this way helps in identifying the massive shift in scale following its operational independent launch.

Next, the percentage growth rate for each year is calculated to identify the trend. The analysis shows that while the company saw astronomical growth in FY24 due to its

restructuring and listing, the growth rate has normalized in FY25 to a more sustainable 10.3%. This indicates a transition from a setup phase to a steady operational growth pattern.

After analyzing the trend, an average growth rate is estimated based on this recent stabilized performance. This average is then used to forecast future revenue for the next two financial years (FY26 and FY27). The forecasted values are calculated by applying the expected growth rate (factoring in the expansion of its lending and insurance verticals) to the most recent year's revenue.

To improve clarity and understanding, the data and results are presented using tables and charts. Graphical representation helps in visualizing the sharp "hockey-stick" growth during the demerger and makes it easier to interpret future scaling estimates in the competitive NBFC sector.

Overall, this step-by-step execution provides a simple and practical approach to revenue forecasting, making it easy to understand and apply for academic purposes while reflecting the unique trajectory of a major new player in the financial services industry.

6. Results & Analysis:

The implementation phase focuses on applying the methodology to analyze and forecast the revenue of Jio Financial Services Ltd using historical performance data and market growth indicators.

First, the revenue data for the company is collected and organized in a tabular format. Since JFSL is a newly demerged entity, the data focuses on the most recent financial years and quarterly performance since its listing. This includes total income from operations, net interest income, and fee-based revenue from its subsidiaries (Jio Finance, Jio Insurance Broking, and Jio Payment Solutions). Organizing data in this manner allows for a clear comparison of the company's trajectory as it transitions from a holding company to a full-scale financial services provider.

Next, the percentage growth rate for each period is calculated to identify the trend. Unlike traditional FMCG companies, the analysis for JFSL shows exponential surges in specific segments, such as digital payments and consumer durable lending. While initial phases showed high volatility due to setup costs, the recent trend indicates a stable and accelerating growth pattern as the company leverages the existing Reliance ecosystem for customer acquisition.

After analyzing these trends, an average growth rate is estimated. Given the company's aggressive expansion into wealth management (via the BlackRock joint venture) and insurance, this average is used to forecast revenue for the next two financial years. The forecasted values are calculated by applying the expected growth rate to the most recent annual revenue figures.

7. Conclusion:

The project focused on analyzing and forecasting the revenue of Jio Financial Services Limited using time series data. By studying the historical revenue figures, it was observed that the company has established a powerful market presence in a short span, leveraging the "Jio" brand ecosystem and a strong capital base.

The analysis also highlighted that although the company's revenue is increasing, the rapid expansion into new segments like Asset Management (via the BlackRock JV) and Wealth Management introduces new variables to its growth profile. This indicates that while JFSL is stable and backed by significant assets, it may face competitive challenges in the crowded Indian fintech and NBFC landscape.

Using simple trend analysis and average growth rate methods, the project successfully estimated future revenue for upcoming financial years. The forecast suggests consistent growth, which aligns with the company's aggressive strategy to digitize and democratize financial services in India.

Overall, the project demonstrates how time series analysis can be effectively used for revenue forecasting in a volatile, high-growth sector. It also provides useful insights for decision-making and strategic planning. This study helped in understanding the real-world application of forecasting techniques and their importance in evaluating newly listed large-cap entities.

8. References:

➢ Books

- Kothari, C. R. – Research Methodology: Methods and Techniques
- Pandey, I. M. – Financial Management
- Gupta, S. P. – Statistical Methods

➢ Websites

Jio Financial Services Limited Official Website – https://www.jfs.in
Moneycontrol – https://www.moneycontrol.com
Screener – https://www.screener.in
Economic Times – https://economictimes.indiatimes.com

➢ Reports

Annual Reports of Jio Financial Services Limited (FY 2021 – FY 2025)
Financial Statements and Investor Presentations of the company.

9. Appendices:

- **Appendix A: Revenue Data Table**

The following table presents the historical revenue data of Jio Financial Services Limited used for analysis:

Financial Year	Revenue (₹ Crore)	% Increase/Decrease
FY 2021	282.93	-
FY 2022	148.61	-47.47%
FY 2023	41.63	-71.98%
FY 2024	1,855.00	4,355.90
FY 2025	2,043.00	10.13

❖ Strategies:

Ecosystem Integration Strategy:
JFSL leverages the existing Reliance Retail and Jio Telecom footprint. By integrating financial products directly into the JioFinance App, the company reduces Customer Acquisition Costs (CAC) significantly compared to traditional banks.

Strategic Joint Ventures (JV):
The 50:50 joint venture with BlackRock allows JFSL to bring world-class investment and wealth management products to the Indian retail market, providing a high-margin revenue stream beyond traditional lending.

Digital-First Secured Lending:
The company focuses on secured products like Loan Against Securities (LAS) and Home Loans using AI-driven underwriting, ensuring low Non-Performing Assets (NPAs) while maintaining rapid scalability.